

Walk Before Me

A Journey Through Psalm 26

Emmaus Road Study Series · The Path of Integrity

Psalm 26:1-12

Build: August 27, 2026 · Template proof, teaching prose pending

Opening paragraph. Warm voice, communal we and us. Sets the psalm in one breath and sends the reader into the text.

I. The Appeal

Psalm 26:1-3 · companion witness: Genesis 17:1 (outside Psalm 26)

Judge me, O LORD, for I haue walked in mine integritie: I haue trusted also in the LORD, therefore I shall not slide. Examine me, O LORD, and proue me: trie my reines and my heart. For thy louing kindnesse is before mine eyes: and I haue walked in thy trueth.

Psalm 26:1-3, 1611 KJV (provisional, see Validation Status)

David opens by inviting God's scrutiny, a bold declaration of transparency.

Pending the notebook pages. Teaching prose goes here.

Question carried into the reflection: Does the walk begin with our strength, or His name?

II. The Refusal

Psalm 26:4-5 · companion witness: Psalm 25:21 (outside Psalm 26)

Block quote: Psalm 26:4-5, 1611 KJV, transcribed from the physical copy. Right-aligned citation follows automatically.

A conscious, deliberate separation from the deceitful and wicked.

Pending the notebook pages. Teaching prose goes here.

Question carried into the reflection: Is integrity a claim of sinlessness, or a plea for preservation?

III. The Ritual

Psalm 26:6-7 · companion witness: Psalm 26:1, 3

Block quote: Psalm 26:6-7, 1611 KJV, transcribed from the physical copy. Right-aligned citation follows automatically.

Washing hands in innocence to approach the altar of the Lord.

Pending the notebook pages. Teaching prose goes here.

Question carried into the reflection: Which holds the man: the walk, or the trust?

IV. The Affection

Psalm 26:8 · companion witness: Psalm 26:2

Block quote: Psalm 26:8, 1611 KJV, transcribed from the physical copy. Right-aligned citation follows automatically.

A profound, emotional declaration of love for God's dwelling place.

Pending the notebook pages. Teaching prose goes here.

Question carried into the reflection: Do we open the inner rooms to the One we trust?

V. The Petition

Psalm 26:9-10 · companion witness: Psalm 26:9-11

Block quote: Psalm 26:9-10, 1611 KJV, transcribed from the physical copy. Right-aligned citation follows automatically.

A desperate plea to not be gathered with sinners.

Pending the notebook pages. Teaching prose goes here.

Question carried into the reflection: Where does our integrity meet His mercy?

VI. The Resolve

Psalm 26:11

Block quote: Psalm 26:11, 1611 KJV, transcribed from the physical copy. Right-aligned citation follows automatically.

A renewed commitment to integrity and a cry for redemption.

Pending the notebook pages. Teaching prose goes here.

Question carried into the reflection: What does a resolve born of dependence look like in our week?

VII. The Stand

Psalm 26:12

Block quote: Psalm 26:12, 1611 KJV, transcribed from the physical copy. Right-aligned citation follows automatically.

The final destination: standing firmly on level ground, praising the Lord.

Pending the notebook pages. Teaching prose goes here.

Question carried into the reflection: When does private integrity become public praise?

Closing paragraph. Gathers the seven movements into the psalm's own last line and names what the walk was for.

Hebrew and Greek Word Study

Script with transliteration and Strong's number, per house standard. All numbers provisional pending concordance check.

Script	Transliteration	Strong's	Meaning	In the Text
תָּם	<i>Tom</i>	pending	Integrity; completeness; uprightness	Forms the baseline requirement for approaching the altar. It is not sinless perfection, but an undivided heart.
מִישָׁרִים	<i>Meshar</i>	pending	Equity; level path; uprightness	Describes the resulting stability when one walks in Tom. The psalmist stands on level ground amidst chaos.
πύρωσον	<i>Pyroson</i>	pending	Divine refinement; test by fire	An active plea for God to purify the believer's motives. The walk of integrity welcomes the refining fire to burn away impurities.

Further word entries from the notebook pages. Rows extend downward; the script column is FreeSerif at size 26 with right-to-left set on the run only.

Witness Table, Emmaus Road Order

Torah, then the Prophets, then the Writings, then the Fulfillment in Christ (Luke 24:27, 44). Two or three witnesses for every claim. Grades are honest, not curated. The grade measures the strength of the link between witness and claim, not the authority of Scripture.

Witness	Division	What It Establishes	Grade
	Torah		
	Nevi'im		
	Ketuvim		
	Fulfillment		

Rows are empty by design. No witness enters this study without a Berean grade, and none has been graded yet.

Guards Applied

Each guard below is raised by the source material itself or by the standing project instructions. None was invented for this build.

Guard	Basis
Integrity is not sinlessness	The app commentary on Psalm 26:11 states it directly: the claim of integrity is not a claim of sinlessness, and the immediate follow-up is the cry redeem me.
God knows hearts, He does not read them	Project instruction, standing globally. Psalm 26:2 asks God to try the reins and the heart. Omniscience, not inference.
God proves, He does not tempt with evil	Project instruction from James 1:13, standing globally. Psalm 26:2 is a plea to be examined and proved.
Remez requires New Testament warrant	Project instruction. Any forward reading from Psalm 26 needs an explicit cross-reference, or it is held back.

Validation Status

This document is a template proof. The format is final; the teaching content is not written. Grading below describes the build, not a finished study.

Graded Strong

- Format compliance. US Letter at 12240 by 15840 DXA, one inch margins, Garamond specified on every run, Zechariah 4:6 running footer on every page, indented italic scripture blocks with right-aligned citation, FreeSerif at size 26 on all three font slots for Hebrew and Greek with right-to-left set on runs only.
- Waypoint structure. The seven movements, their passages, summaries and questions are transcribed without alteration from the study data in the Walk Before Me Journey repository.

Graded Moderate

- The 1611 block quote at movement I. Rendered from standard 1611 orthography and not proofread against the physical copy. It is present to prove the block-quote format, not as final text.
- Hebrew and Greek script forms in the word study. The pointed forms are standard for the transliterations the source supplies, but the source itself carries no script column, so these were supplied in this build.

Held Back

- All Strong's numbers. The source carries none. Guessing them would violate the standing rule against fabricated references, so every entry reads pending.
- All teaching prose. Nothing interpretive has been written. The slots are empty on purpose.

- The entire witness table. No witness has been graded, so no witness appears.
- Movement I and II anchor verses. The source pairs movement I with Genesis 17:1 and movement II with Psalm 25:21, both outside Psalm 26. Whether those belong in a Psalm 26 study as companion witnesses or as design choices from the mockup is an open question for the notebook pages to settle.

Open Decisions

- Naming scheme. Two exist and neither is canonical. The verse-by-verse scheme (The Appeal, The Refusal, The Ritual, The Affection, The Petition, The Resolve, The Stand) is used as the spine here; the Emmaus Road scheme (Covenant Ground, The Prayer Beneath, The Walk and The Trust, The Door Opened, The Petition, The Resolve, The Even Place) is carried in the Quick Reference Card so both stay visible.

Standard Proofread Flag

All block-quoted 1611 text, including period spelling, and all Strong's numbers are provisional pending proofread against the physical 1611 and the concordance before print or teaching.